likely to be dependent on others for awhile; as much as India wanted to be self-sufficient and unaffected by others' decisions, the reality was different. Attaining autonomy required pursuing partnerships, and building independence required accepting some level of dependence.

Given that reality, what emerged and evolved over time was a strategy that Indian leaders, acting from weakness and operating under political, economic, and geopolitical constraints, employed to expand their options. Essentially, what they developed was a strategy of diversification. Most Indian policymakers tried to reduce dependence on external sources as much as possible; at the very least, they strove to diversify it. They sought to do this by establishing and maintaining relationships with multiple countries in order to maximize benefits and minimize risks to Indian objectives. These goals included not only security and prosperity but also autonomy.

Policymakers hoped diversification (1) would allow India to benefit from various partners, (2) would minimize too much dependence on any one partner, (3) would reduce the demands of dependence in terms of the strings attached to external assistance—or the necessity to go along with a particular partner's interests and actions because India had no choice, and (4) would protect against the questionable reliability of any one partner. And this approach to partnerships—this diversification strategy—has continued to the present day.

Since the world is no longer divided into two blocs (or three), some have argued that nonalignment is an irrelevant concept. What this book has tried to show is that in considering Indian foreign policy it is important to look at the strategy of diversification underlying nonalignment rather than the concept of nonalignment itself. That strategy has been remarkably consistent across time. Despite shocks in 1962 and 1991, which observers highlight as key turning points in Indian foreign policy, diversification has persisted. They apply this approach not just in terms of developing and maintaining multiple partnerships, but also, for example, in arms acquisition policy and international energy sourcing. Diversification requires options, however, and as this book has shown, India's available options will be determined not just by how India sees potential partners but by how these partners conceive of India's role and relative importance in their broader strategies.